

Grammar reference

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1 Adjectives ending in **-ed** and **-ing**

1.1 Adjectives ending in **-ed**

Adjectives ending in **-ed** or have the same form as the past participle of a verb, e.g. *amazed, relieved, terrified, thrilled*. We often use them to describe people's feelings. They normally follow *be, feel, seem, look, etc.*
*I was **amazed** to hear I'd won the prize.*
*What's the matter? You **seem** a bit **annoyed**.*

1.2 Adjectives ending in **-ing**

We use these adjectives to describe the effect that experiences or events have on us. They can be used before the noun or after *be* and other linking verbs.
*That was a **terrifying** experience.*
*The explanation was rather **confusing**.*

2 Adverbs

2.1 Formation of adverbs from adjectives

- 1 Many adverbs are formed by adding **-ly** to the adjective form of the word, e.g. *clear – clearly*.
For adjectives ending in **-y**, drop the **y** and add **-ily**, e.g. *happy, happily*.
For adjectives ending in **-le**, drop the **e** and add **-ly**, e.g. *gentle, gently*.
For adjectives ending in **-ic**, add **-ally**, e.g. *automatic, automatically*.
- 2 Some words ending in **-ly** are adjectives only, not adverbs, e.g. *cowardly, friendly, silly*. If an adverb is needed, a phrase must be used.
*They greeted us **in a friendly way/manner**.*
- 3 Some words ending in **-ly** can be used both as adjectives and adverbs, e.g. *hourly, daily, nightly*.
*Take the medicine twice **daily** (adv.).*
*There is a **daily** (adj.) flight to the island.*
- 4 Some adverbs have the same form as adjectives, e.g. *early, fast, hard, still, straight; better, best, worse, worst*.
*He's got a **fast** (adj.) car and he drives it **fast** (adv.).*
*She has **straight** (adj.) hair. He looked **straight** (adv.) at me.*
- 5 Some adverbs have two forms, one like the adjective and the other form ending in **-ly**, e.g. *clear, close, direct, easy, free, hard, high, late*. There is usually a difference in meaning.
*Stand **clear** of the doors. (= keep away)*
*Try to speak more **clearly**. (= so we can understand)*
*He works very **hard**. (= he makes a lot of effort)*
*He had **hardly** any petrol left. (= almost none)*
*The balloon was **high** up in the sky. (= a long way up)*
*They think very **highly** of you. (= have a good opinion)*
*Children under 12 travel **free**. (= they don't have to pay)*
*You can walk **freely** in the hotel grounds. (= without restrictions)*
*The train arrived **late**. He's not been very well **lately**. (= recently)*

2.2 Comparison of adverbs

The comparison of adverbs is similar to that of adjectives. See 4.5.

2.3 Adverbs of manner

These adverbs are used to say how the action of the verb is carried out.

- 1 Common adverbs of manner include: *accurately, badly, carefully, patiently, straight, well*.

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1 Adjectives ending in -ed and -ing

1.1 Adjectives ending in -ed

Adjectives ending in -ed or have the same form as the past participle of a verb. e.g. amazed, relieved, terrified, thrilled. We often use them to describe people's feelings. They normally follow be, feel, seem, look, etc.

I was amazed to hear I'd won the prize.

What's the matter? You seem a bit annoyed.

1.2 Adjectives ending in -ing

We use these adjectives to describe the effect that experiences or events have on us. They can be used before the noun or after be and other linking verbs.

That was a terrifying experience.

The explanation was rather confusing.

2 Adverbs

2.1 Formation of adverbs from adjectives

1 Many adverbs are formed by adding -ly to the adjective form of the word. e.g. clear - clearly.

For adjectives ending in -y, drop the y and add -ily, e.g. happy, happily

For adjectives ending in -le, drop the e and add -ly. e.g. gentle, gently

For adjectives ending in -ic, add -ally, e.g. automatic, automatically.

2 Some words ending in -ly are adjectives only, not adverbs, e.g. cowardly, friendly, silly. If an adverb is needed, a phrase must be used.

They greeted us in a friendly way/manner.

3 Some words ending in -ly can be used both as adjectives and adverbs, e.g. hourly, daily, nightly.

Take the medicine twice daily (adv.). There is a daily (adj.) flight to the island.

4 Some adverbs have the same form as adjectives, e.g. early, fast, hard, still, straight; better, worse, worst. He's got a fast (adj.) car and he drives it fast (adv.). She has straight (adj.) hair. He looked straight (adv.) at me.

5 Some adverbs have two forms, one like the adjective and the other form ending in -ly, e.g. clear, close, direct, easy,

free, hard, high, late. There is usually a difference in meaning.

Stand clear of the doors. (= keep away)

Try to speak more clearly. (- so we can understand) He works very hard. (- he makes a lot of effort) He had hardly any petrol left. (= almost none) The balloon was high up in the sky. (= a long way up) They think very highly of you. (= have a good opinion) Children under 12 travel free. (= they don't have to pay) You can walk freely in the hotel grounds. (= without restrictions)

The train arrived late. He's not been very well lately. (recently)

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See 4.5.

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